

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 9

New Case: Rohan (26 y/o) – Contamination OCD + Checking
Highly Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Rohan (26 years, Male, Software Engineer, Bangalore)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	9 of 18–20	Focus:	Continuing ERP + Reviewing Progress

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking more confident and engaged than previous sessions. He practiced the shaking hands exposure at home 3 times with good habituation. He reported that anxiety is decreasing faster with repeated practice and that he is delaying other compulsions more consistently. He continues to use labeling effectively. Today's plan: Review home ERP practice in detail, continue ERP with the next hierarchy item (touching a public toilet door handle), reinforce progress and coping skills, and assign new homework. Maintain supportive and encouraging approach.

SESSION START – HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Rohan. How has your week been? I'm curious to hear how the shaking hands practice at home went.

Client: (speaking with more confidence) It went quite well. I practiced shaking hands with a colleague I trust three times. The first time, anxiety went up to around 55–60 and took about 10–11 minutes to come down significantly. By the third time, it only went up to around 40 and came down faster — in about 6–7 minutes. I was able to delay washing for much longer each time. I also noticed that on days when I used labeling quickly, other contamination urges felt more manageable too. I still washed more than I ideally want to, but I'm delaying significantly more often now.

Therapist: That's excellent continued progress. You're clearly experiencing faster habituation with repeated practice — the anxiety is rising less and coming down quicker. You're also generalizing the labeling skill effectively. How are you feeling about these changes?

Client: I feel more hopeful and a bit proud. Each practice is getting a bit easier, and I'm seeing that I can handle more than I thought. I'm still nervous about some of the higher items on the list, but I think I can keep going.

CONTINUING ERP – NEXT HIERARCHY ITEM

Therapist: Since you're making consistent progress, I'd like to suggest we move to the next item on your hierarchy today in session — touching a public toilet door handle (using tissue first) and then delaying washing for a longer period (aiming for 12–15 minutes). We can practice it here first. How does that sound?

Client: I think I can try that. It feels scarier than shaking hands, but I'm more confident after the last few practices.

Therapist: That's completely understandable. Let's do it step by step. I'll ask you to touch this door handle (representing a public toilet door, using tissue first as per your hierarchy). Then we'll stay with whatever thoughts and anxiety come up, using labeling and breathing. We'll aim to delay washing for at least 12–15 minutes. Ready when you are.

(In-session exposure conducted: Rohan touched the door handle using tissue. Initial anxiety rose to around 65/100 with strong urge to wash. He practiced labeling and breathing. After 14 minutes, anxiety decreased to around 20/100. He reported that the urge weakened significantly over time, though it was stronger than previous exposures. Post-exposure processing done.)

Therapist: How was that experience for you?

Client: It was harder than the shaking hands one, but I could handle it. The anxiety went up more, especially right after touching the handle, but it still came down after some time. I feel tired now, but also relieved and a bit proud that I was able to wait without washing immediately.

Therapist: That's a significant step forward. You tolerated higher anxiety and still experienced strong habituation. This builds real confidence that you can handle more difficult real-life situations. How are you feeling about practicing this one at home?

Client: I think I can try it 2 times this week. I'm still nervous, but today's practice helped a lot.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

- Practice touching a public toilet door handle (using tissue) and delaying washing for 12–15 minutes (2 times)
- Continue practicing the shaking hands exposure at home
- Continue labeling and monitoring

Client: I'll try the toilet door handle one. I feel more prepared after today's session.

Therapist: Excellent. We'll review how it went next session.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your strong progress at home, did the next hierarchy item in session (public toilet door handle), and saw excellent habituation. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: I feel more confident than before. Each exposure is getting a bit easier, and I'm seeing that I can handle more than I thought. I'm still scared of some higher items, but I think I can keep going.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. Any questions before we finish?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed continued strong progress in ERP. Successfully completed fifth hierarchy item in session with excellent habituation.
- Client reported increased confidence and faster habituation with repeated practice.
- Motivation and engagement remain high. Client is gradually building tolerance to higher anxiety levels.
- Next session: Review home ERP practice, continue ERP with next hierarchy item if ready, reinforce coping skills and self-compassion, address any emerging difficulties.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.